

CARNEGIE MELLON - TEPPER SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT TEPPER

Tepper School of Business at Carnegie Mellon is one of the smallest among the top 20 business schools, boasting a close-knit culture and pioneering approach to management curriculum (a “management science” model over the case method, that’s now integrated within all the leading business schools).

Tepper’s central location within the Carnegie Mellon campus provides MBA candidates with access to the university’s most sought after assets and networks. In 2018, the sparkling Tepper Quad made its debut: a physical space that functions as an innovation hub for the entire seven-college campus, reinforcing the university’s focus on cross-pollination. This means Tepper MBAs are encouraged to collaborate with students from the six other schools including engineering, computer science, information technology, and design. Tepper is renowned for its focus on research and technology, so partnerships between other lauded centers on campus like AI, robotics and big data is at the center of its interdisciplinary approach.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Industry and Operations, Finance and IT

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
BusinessWeek	14	13	15	15	*	19
Financial Times	38	40	35	31	27	23
Forbes	18	-	17	-	-	-
The Economist	30	33	31	-	9	*
US News	19	17	17	19	16	16

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	2,267	Avg Work Experience	5.8
MBA Class Size	192	Avg GMAT	702
Total Tuition	US\$145,600	Avg GPA	3.33
Admissions Selectivity	28.8%	Avg Age	29
Yield	US\$0.2941	% International	56%
		% Women	31%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Consulting	39.1%
Technology	28.1%
Finance	16.4%
Biotech/Health/Pharma	6.2%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, Deloitte, Microsoft, PwC, Boston Consulting Group, McKinsey & Company, EY Parthenon, Bain & Company, Google, AlixPartners, Capital One Financial Corporation, Jefferies Group, TATA Consultancy Services

AVERAGE BASE SALARY:	US\$148,067
SALARY INCREASE:	127%
EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS:	97%



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR CARNEGIE MELLON TEPPER APPLICATION

BY CATHERINE TUTTLE

Catherine brings deep MBA experience as a former Associate Director at Duke University's Fuqua School of Business. For five years she worked in the Career Management Center creating, implementing, and evaluating programs and coaching MBA's to achieve their career goals. She also served as the liaison to Admissions having worked with them earlier in her career as a Marketing Manager.



**The admissions committee seeks
students who define community in the
broadest sense of the word and have a
desire to effect positive change.**

1

EVIDENCE OF IMPACT

Impact on the bottom line, but also impact within your community. Tepper is guided by a mission to transform the world. They are looking for students who define community in the broadest sense of the word and have a desire to effect positive change. This theme is seen in the first essay option where they ask, "What difference will you make as a member of the MBA class at the Tepper School?" They want leaders who are functioning at a higher, more advanced level with a focus on something greater than themselves. Scanning through the list of 40+ clubs you'll find a wide variety of opportunities to give back while getting involved including Tepper Cares, Pro Bono Consulting, Net Impact, and Out & Allied. Think about where you've had an impact in the past and how that will translate on-campus.

DEMONSTRATE A GROWTH MINDSET

2

Show an ability to learn from experience and those around you.

Your ability to learn from mistakes and willingness to seek candid feedback from others demonstrates a desire to grow personally and professionally. The MBA experience is transformative in both of these areas – expect to push yourself and grow beyond what you imagined was possible. Tepper's focus on innovation and collaboration means they are looking for students who are adaptable, open to new ideas and coming from a variety of backgrounds, job experiences, and passions. When crafting your narrative, it's important to be clear about the strengths in your profile, but also the desire to learn from those around you.

3

KNOW WHAT INCLUSIVE COMMUNITY MEANS

With a small class size of 200, Tepper places a high value on creating an inclusive, diverse, and tight-knit community – one that’s committed to making a positive impact on each other, business, and the world. As such, the admissions team is looking for evidence of self-reflection and your ability to appreciate differences as a profound asset to a culture of innovation. In a statement to prospective students, the Executive Director of Community & Inclusion articulates, “We value each individual and acknowledge the intersectionality across the various dimensions of identity – who you are and how you define yourself. We strive to build an environment in which people can engage in and learn from each other’s differences and perspectives.” This really speaks to the type of class that Tepper strives to craft, and a recognition of the diverse range of students who apply. Accept the challenge – and opportunity – to convey a deep level of introspection and purpose.

COLLABORATION IS THE KEY TO SUCCESS

4

And not just collaboration within the MBA program, but across campus. This is why the Tepper Quad was opened in late 2018 with the vision of interconnecting all seven campus colleges. Ultimately, the goal was to create a space for the intersection of business, technology, and analytics. Students learn from each other alongside professors, entrepreneurs, designers, and computer scientists. When preparing your materials, you’ll want to think about examples that show initiative and innovation, but also cross-functional collaboration, and global reach. Almost all schools would describe their culture as collaborative, but few take it as far.

5

INNOVATION IS AT THE HEART OF THE EXPERIENCE

Tepper sees itself as constantly moving forward with new ideas and creative approaches. Throughout your application (resume, essays, letters of recommendation, etc.) you want to showcase your ability to anticipate and resolve pressing problems. Admissions wants to see evidence of your initiative. What inspired you to take action? How did you rally others around your cause or overcome resistance to change? How did you bridge viewpoints from different stakeholders? What was the impact? Make sure to highlight your innovative spirit, your ability to set a strategic vision, and your collaborative approach to problem solving across your narrative.

Read insider essay strategies for Tepper [here](#).

DEADLINES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION
Round 1	02 October 2023	06 December 2023
Round 2	08 January 2024	06 March 2024
Round 3	04 March 2024	08 May 2024
Round 4	06 May 2024	05 June 2024



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

